Lluc Santamaria Riba

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Experience

Associate AI Engineer, Prosper AI (YC S23, $30M Series A by a16z)
Barcelona, Spain | Aug 2026 – Present

- Cut the silence before the agent's first word by 90% at the median and eliminated waits over 5 s
- Made every agent reply 20% faster by moving OpenAI inference to the Responses API over WebSocket

Research Fellow, University of California, Irvine
Irvine, California, United States | Feb 2026 – Jul 2026

- Built the first public implementation of the leximin core algorithm from Vazirani's ACM EC paper
- Validated runtime and memory scaling across 1,320 benchmark instances; defended the thesis with distinction

Equity Analyst, Investment Society Lausanne
Lausanne, Switzerland | Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

- Pitched Melexis and Magyar Telekom into a 25k CHF fund at 75%+ approval; both gained 28% and 53% within 8 months

Machine Learning Research Intern, Barcelona Supercomputing Center
Barcelona, Spain | Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

- Fine-tuned CodeLlama 7B into the first LLM able to generate parallelized PyCOMPSs code on MareNostrum 5
- Built 30+ parallel applications and a unit-tested pipeline turning them into 2 training datasets

Software Engineer Intern, ALBA Synchrotron
Cerdanyola del Vallès, Spain | Oct 2024 – Apr 2025

- Shipped features across 3 internal Django and AngularJS apps in a 12-person Scrum team
- Co-built the state machine digitalizing ALBA's hiring process and revamped the beamline app's UI across 3 breakpoints

Projects

Scala 3 Compiler: Divergence Checking for Match Types – scala/scala3 PR #24661

- Designed a static termination check with Martin Odersky, Scala's creator, now a formal Scala Improvement Process (SIP)

CardioRisk, Heart Disease Prediction from Scratch – github.com/Lluc24/CardioRisk

- Hit 0.868 accuracy and 0.424 F1 on 328K CDC records with a 90:10 class imbalance, using from-scratch NumPy models

ClearPath, Voice Agent for Medical Intake – Y Combinator Voice Agents Hackathon

- Built a Pipecat, Twilio and Daily voice agent that fills medical intake forms from speech in about 90 seconds

Healix, Encrypted Mood Journal on the Sui Blockchain – SUI Foundation Hackathon 2025

- Won $1,000 with an encrypted mood-journal platform; wrote Move contracts gated by SEAL access control

Education

Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya (UPC) – BSc in Informatics Engineering
Barcelona, Spain | Sep 2022 – Jun 2026

- Graduated ranked 1st of nearly 400 students, with honors in 16 of 27 courses, and elected delegate for 3 courses

École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL) – Exchange, Computer Science
Lausanne, Switzerland | Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

- Completed Master-level coursework with top marks; researched the Scala 3 compiler with Martin Odersky

Awards and Scholarships

- **Balsells Fellowship** – funded research fellowship awarded to up to 3 Catalan engineering students per semester
- **UPC Highest GPA Award** – ranked 1st of nearly 400 students
- **SUI Foundation Hackathon 2025** – Winner

Skills & Languages

- **Voice & Speech:** Pipecat, Deepgram, Cartesia, Twilio, Telnyx, WebRTC, Daily
- **Backend:** Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Docker, Linux, AsyncIO
- **Frontend:** TypeScript, React, Next.js
- **Languages:** Catalan and Spanish (native); English (proficient – Cambridge C1 Advanced, 183)